

Parent-teen relationships

The family dynamic evolves as a teen matures, and can test the parent-teen relationship. With both sides feeling mixed emotions, this time can be challenging.

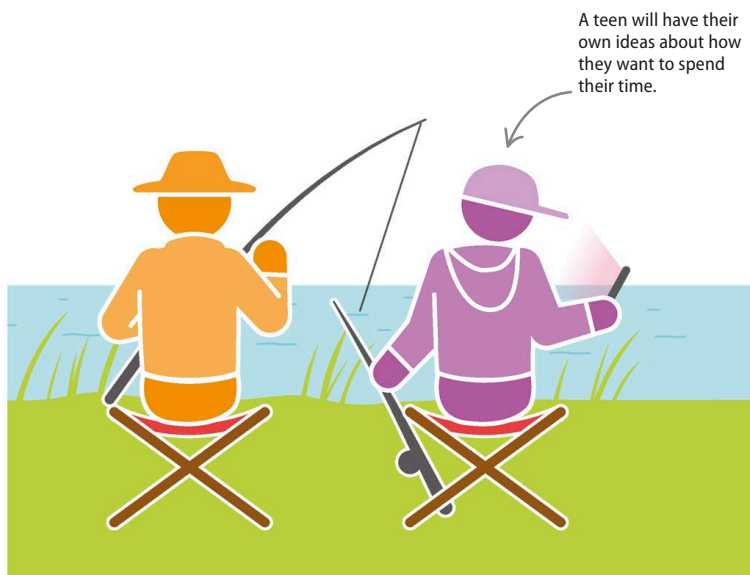
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Changing relationships

Puberty brings lots of emotions for teens, and is a time of readjustment for the whole family. Parents have a huge influence on a young child's values and interests, and so it can often feel hard for them to separate from their teen, who wants to develop their own identity and to have new freedoms. This may lead to conflict, as both parents and teens need time to figure out how to adapt the relationship.

▷ Different interests

Both parents and teens are likely to feel confused at times about their relationship. Working out a new dynamic can take time, and both sides might experience some feelings of frustration.



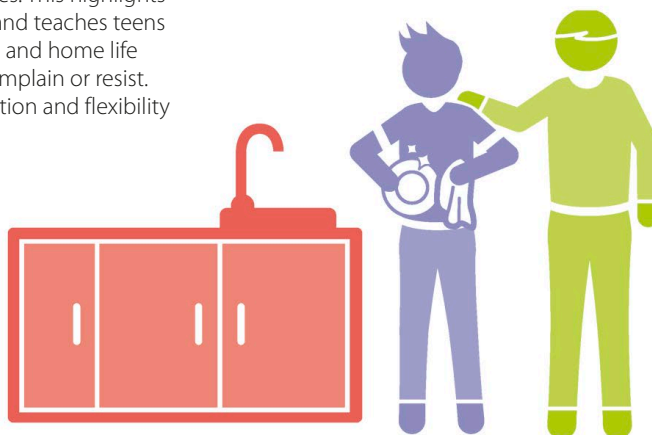
Routine and expectations

As teens get older, it is important for them to take on responsibilities. This highlights the valuable contribution each family member makes to a home, and teaches teens about what it's like to be an adult. Setting clear rules about routine and home life helps teens to know what's expected of them—even if they do complain or resist. Expectations go both ways, however, and so constant communication and flexibility when necessary will help avoid conflict.

PARENT TIPS

Creating structure

- Ensure that teens know how much their contribution to completing chores is valued. Encouragement is more effective than criticism.
- Regularly discuss with your teen what you expect them to do within a clear time frame, and what you'll do in return.
- Model what you are asking for to show what you expect. More clarity will mean fewer arguments.



△ Household chores

Acknowledge the instances when your teen does something right, and particularly when they do something without being asked.